



Regulation (EU) 2021/784 on addressing the dissemination of Terrorist Content Online Transparency Report

The European Parliament and the Council of the European Union have introduced regulation (EU) 2021/784 with regards to hosting terrorist content on certain online platforms. Google is committed to promoting transparency for the users of our platforms as to the action taken to address the dissemination of terrorist content.

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Regulation (EU) 2021/784 on addressing the dissemination of Terrorist Content Online

Overview

Google is committed to preventing terrorists from exploiting our products and services. Google's Terms of Service prohibit using any of Google's products or services to share terrorist content. Our teams work diligently to identify and remove this content, using a combination of industry-leading automated detection tools and specially-trained human reviewers.

This report describes Google's efforts and resources to combat terrorist content for the period from June 7, 2022 to December 31, 2022.

Measures taken to address the dissemination of terrorist content online

Information about measures taken by the “hosting service” provider, as defined under the Terrorist Content Online Regulation, in relation to the identification and removal of or disabling of access to terrorist content

Content produced by or in support of terrorist organisations is prohibited on our products that host user-generated content. Terrorist organisations are also prohibited from using our services for any purpose, including recruitment. In addition, our policies prohibit content that promotes terrorism, such as content that glorifies terrorist acts or incites violence. Google works extensively with government, law enforcement, and civil society groups to tackle the problem of violent extremism online and to ensure that there is no place for terrorist content on our services.

To enforce our policies, we rely on a combination of automated and human efforts to identify potentially violative content. Users can report potentially violative content via in-product tools. In addition, our automated systems are trained to quickly identify violative content. This includes flagging potentially problematic content for human reviewers, whose judgement is needed for the many decisions that require a more nuanced determination.

The context in which a piece of content is created or shared is an important factor in any assessment about its quality or its purpose. If users are posting content related to terrorism for an educational, documentary, scientific, or artistic purpose, we encourage them to be mindful to provide enough information so that viewers can understand the context.

Across our policy areas, Google continues to support the network of government partners and non-governmental organisations (NGOs) who bring valuable expertise to our enforcement systems, including through YouTube's Trusted Flagger program. In the context of violent extremism, this includes NGOs and government agencies focused on counterterrorism. Participants in the Trusted Flagger program receive training to identify content that violates YouTube's Community Guidelines and, because their flags have a higher action rate than the average user, we prioritize them for review. Content flagged by Trusted Flaggers is subject to the same policies as content flagged by any other user and is reviewed by our teams who are trained to make decisions on whether content violates Community Guidelines and should be removed.

Information on the “hosting service” provider, as defined under the Terrorist Content Online Regulation, measures to address the reappearance online of material which has previously been removed or to which access has been disabled because it was considered to be terrorist content, in particular where automated tools have been used

Google has long invested in automated, machine learning technology to aid in the detection of content that may violate our policies. Google products - such as YouTube - use this machine learning technology to detect re-uploads of violative content, in many cases before it is widely viewed by users. In addition, we use hash matching (or “digital fingerprints”) technology to detect known violent extremist content. Previously reviewed content determined to be violative of our policies is hashed, and these hashes are compared against other content hosted on our products. When a match is found, the content is reviewed to verify whether it indeed violates our policies. If it does, the content is removed and is used to train our machines for better coverage in the future.

In 2016, YouTube created a [hash-sharing database](#) with industry partners where we share hashes of terrorist content to stop its spread. The shared database currently contains approximately [370,000 unique hashes](#) that are near-identical to the human eye. Once content has been hashed, other platforms can use these hashes to help detect related content on their platforms and assess it against their own content policies. This organised effort is now formally operated by the Global Internet Forum to Counter Terrorism (GIFCT), of which YouTube and Google are members. YouTube's vast media library and automated detection systems make us a large contributor of hashes to the hash-sharing database. In accordance with the sharing criteria established by GIFCT, YouTube contributed over 148,000 unique hashes to the hash-sharing database in 2021.

The number of items of terrorist content removed or to which access has been disabled following Removal Orders or Specific Measures

During the reporting period, Google received 0 Removal Orders from Competent Authorities under the Terrorist Content Online Regulation; therefore, there were 0 items of terrorist content removed as a result of Removal Orders. Google and YouTube removed 1,401,390 items of terrorist content due to violations of our policies or Community Guidelines, as well as legal removal orders citing the Terrorist Content Online Regulation (i.e. "Specific Measures" as defined under the Regulation).

Number of items of terrorist content removed following Removal Orders from Competent Authorities

0

Number of items of terrorist content removed following policy/Community Guidelines violations or legal removal orders

1,401,390

The number of removal orders where the content has not been removed or access to which has not been disabled pursuant to the first subparagraph of Article 3(7) and the first subparagraph of Article 3(8), together with the grounds therefor

As Google did not receive any Removal Orders from Competent Authorities during the Reporting Period, there were 0 cases where content was not removed or where access was not disabled.

Number of Removal Orders where the content has not been removed or access to which has not been disabled

0

The number and the outcome of complaints handled by the hosting service provider in accordance with Article 10

During the reporting period, Google handled 15,295 complaints (i.e. appeals) in accordance with our internal complaint handling mechanisms. The vast majority of the original enforcement decisions were upheld as can be seen below.

Number of complaints

15,295

Outcome

Value

Enforcement Decisions Upheld

13,512

Enforcement Decisions Overturned

1,783

The number and the outcome of administrative or judicial review proceedings brought by the “hosting service” provider as defined under the Terrorist Content Online Regulation

Google did not bring any administrative or judicial review proceedings in the reporting period.

Number of administrative or judicial review proceedings

0

The number of cases in which the “hosting service” provider, as defined under the Terrorist Content Online Regulation, was required to reinstate content or access thereto as a result of administrative or judicial review proceedings

As there were no administrative or judicial review proceedings during the reporting period, there were 0 cases in which Google was required to reinstate content or access to content as a result.

Number of reinstatements as a result of administrative or judicial review proceedings

0

Additional Information

• Complaints received from users between June 7, 2022 and December 31, 2022 are included in this report even if the content was actioned prior to the reporting period.